

Nick Cummings

he/him

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead UX Engineer Hidden Door – Portland, OR (Remote) July 2024 – December 2025

- Led a major redesign and expansion of the game from a story generator into a persistent, card-driven, world creation experience across many unique IPs where player expression is at the center of all key mechanics
 - Earned buy-in from the founders and department heads by presenting detailed design documentation: playable prototypes, storyboards, annotated reference materials, and relevant external data
- Developed dozens of major features across the stack, including responsive UI, API architecture, database operations, user accounts/auth, server-authoritative state sync, and building tools to share gameplay moments
- Mentored another engineer via weekly 1:1s, daily check-ins, code and architecture review, and timely feedback

Freelance Game Developer Various – Portland, OR January 2024 – June 2024

Game Developer (Contract), New Beings • January 2024 – February 2024

- Designed, programmed, and launched a desktop and mobile top-down shooter game for a large tech client
- Managed stakeholder expectations on a tight deadline: shared frequent estimates and fought scope creep
- Developed key systems and features: movement, weapons, progression, debug tools, global leaderboards

Software Engineer II Booking.com – Amsterdam, NL September 2022 – July 2023

- Led development and maintenance of an internal strategic architecture mapping tool for leads and directors
 - Developed prototype into a cloud-hosted production application with real-time data and sharing features
 - Fine-tuned UX/interaction patterns, including custom keyboard, mouse, and trackpad controls

Engineering Manager Zapier – Portland, OR (Remote) August 2020 – August 2021

- Built a team from scratch of 3 full-stack engineers who owned the full lifecycle of key internal and user-facing tools for Zapier's in-house support team, from conception through development and supporting in production
- Owned and maintained APIs and interfaces for fetching and contextualizing customer data and product usage
- Led 3-month tech systems migration from Help Scout to Zendesk; launched on schedule without downtime
- Mentored and coached each teammate through weekly 1:1s; identified and tracked goals for personal growth

Freelance Game Developer Various – Portland, OR August 2019 – July 2022

Independent Game Developer • August 2019 – July 2020; September 2021 – August 2022

Part-time Faculty, Portland Community College • August 2019 – February 2020

- Designed and developed *Trash the Planet*, a critically acclaimed narrative/resource-management game
 - Built and led a team of artists, musicians, and writers from prototype to a full-length released game in 18 months
 - Designed and programmed the full game with novel mechanics that evolve and expand in each of its five acts
 - Featured on *Waypoint Radio* and *The Short Game* podcasts; 4.8/5 average rating on itch.io with 300+ reviews
- Built and improved front- and back-end systems for *Be Funny Now!*, a live-service party game on Steam and mobile
- Designed ten new courses for Portland Community College's game development curriculum

Senior Software Engineer Instrument – Portland, OR November 2018 – August 2019

- Worked with clients and internal design teams to build web and live-service VR applications
 - Designed and implemented playback, interaction, and live social features for NBA and NFL VR apps
- Worked with designers and brand owners to build sites for brands like Twitch, One Medical, and Meta
- Mentored junior and mid-level developers with a focus on code quality, sprint planning, and documentation

Software Engineer Squarespace – Portland, OR February 2015 – November 2018

- Developed and supported major Help Center features and updates, including GDPR compliance and live chat
- Established Support Tools Developer role; responsible for user support email/live chat intake systems and support agent tooling; onboarded several new developers to the support systems stack
- Developed internal finance and operations apps that enabled teams to efficiently serve millions of customers
- Co-created and taught Code Camp, a six-week full-stack programming bootcamp for first-time developers

User Operations Specialist Meta – Austin, TX March 2011 – September 2013

- Developed automated systems to find and remove millions of fake accounts, improving CSAT and NPS scores
- Improved account memorialization policies and support process by analyzing thousands of interactions and conducting user interviews across different cultures, resulting in significant trust and satisfaction gains
- Wrote several top 10 Help Center articles to reduce incoming ticket volume; coached and edited other writers

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer Helping Hands — Portland, OR (Remote) April 2020 – July 2020

- Developed user-facing website for a nonprofit COVID-19 support network; kept content and policies updated

Volunteer and Speaker Portland Indie Game Squad — Portland, OR October 2018 – March 2020

- Conducted an educational workshop to introduce non-programmers to source control management with git
- Presented two Talent Talks: “What Is an Interface?” and “Making Interactive Fiction Games with Friends”

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Journalism Robert D. Clark Honors College, September 2004 – September 2008
University of Oregon — Eugene, OR

- Thesis: *The Uses and Gratifications of Communication in Virtual Spaces*
- Associate Editor for *Flux Magazine*; managed 3 story teams of 3-4 reporters, photographers, and designers
 - Gold Crown winner, Columbia Scholastic Press Association, 2009

LANGUAGES

JavaScript/Web – TypeScript, React, Node.js, Astro, Tailwind
Python – Django, Flask
C# – Unity, Godot
GDScript – Godot
Lua – Defold, PICO-8

SKILLS

Technical project management (Scrum, Jira, Trello, Asana) • Interactive storytelling
Visual design (Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud) • Narrative, UX, and technical writing
Cloud (AWS, Azure PlayFab) • Docker and Kubernetes • Accessibility (WCAG)
Observability (Sentry, Honeycomb, PostHog) • Data (Postgres, Prisma, GraphQL)
State management (Colyseus, Overmind, Redux) • Blogging, podcasting, streaming